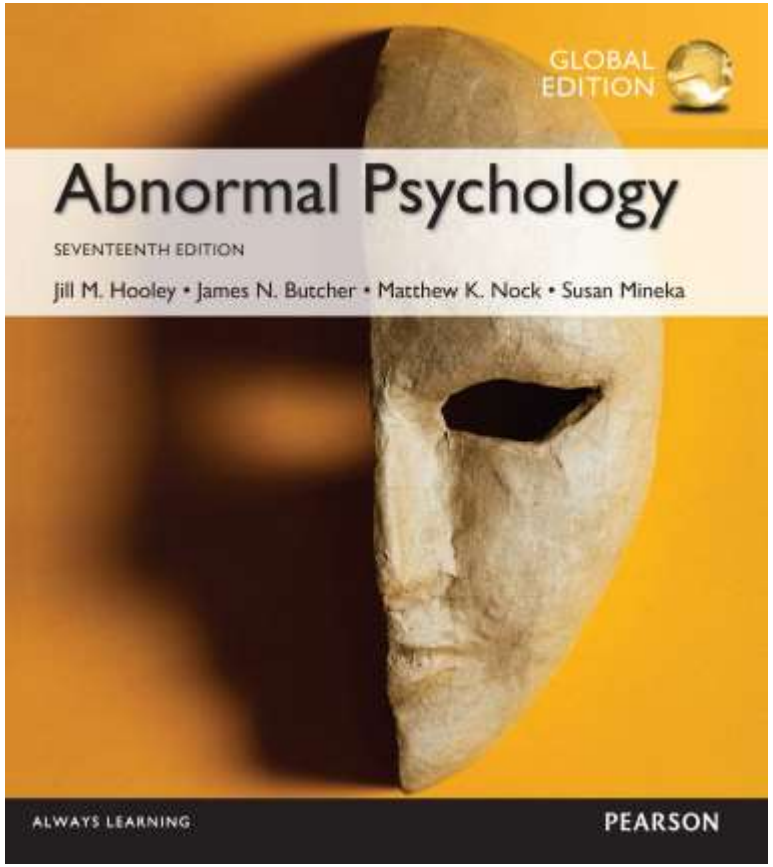
Abnormal Psychology

Seventeenth Edition, Global Edition

Jill M. Hooley | James N. Butcher
Matthew K. Nock | Susan Mineka



Chapter 1

Abnormal Psychology: Overview and Research Approaches

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Learning Objectives (1 of 3)

1.1 Explain how we define abnormality and classify mental disorders.

1.2 Describe the advantages and disadvantages of classification.

1.3 Explain how culture affects what is considered abnormal and describe two different culture-specific disorders.

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Learning Objectives (2 of 3)

1.4 Distinguish between incidence and prevalence and identify the most common and prevalent mental disorders.

1.5 Discuss why abnormal psychology research can be conducted in almost any setting.

1.6 Describe three different approaches used to gather information about mental disorders.

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Learning Objectives (3 of 3)

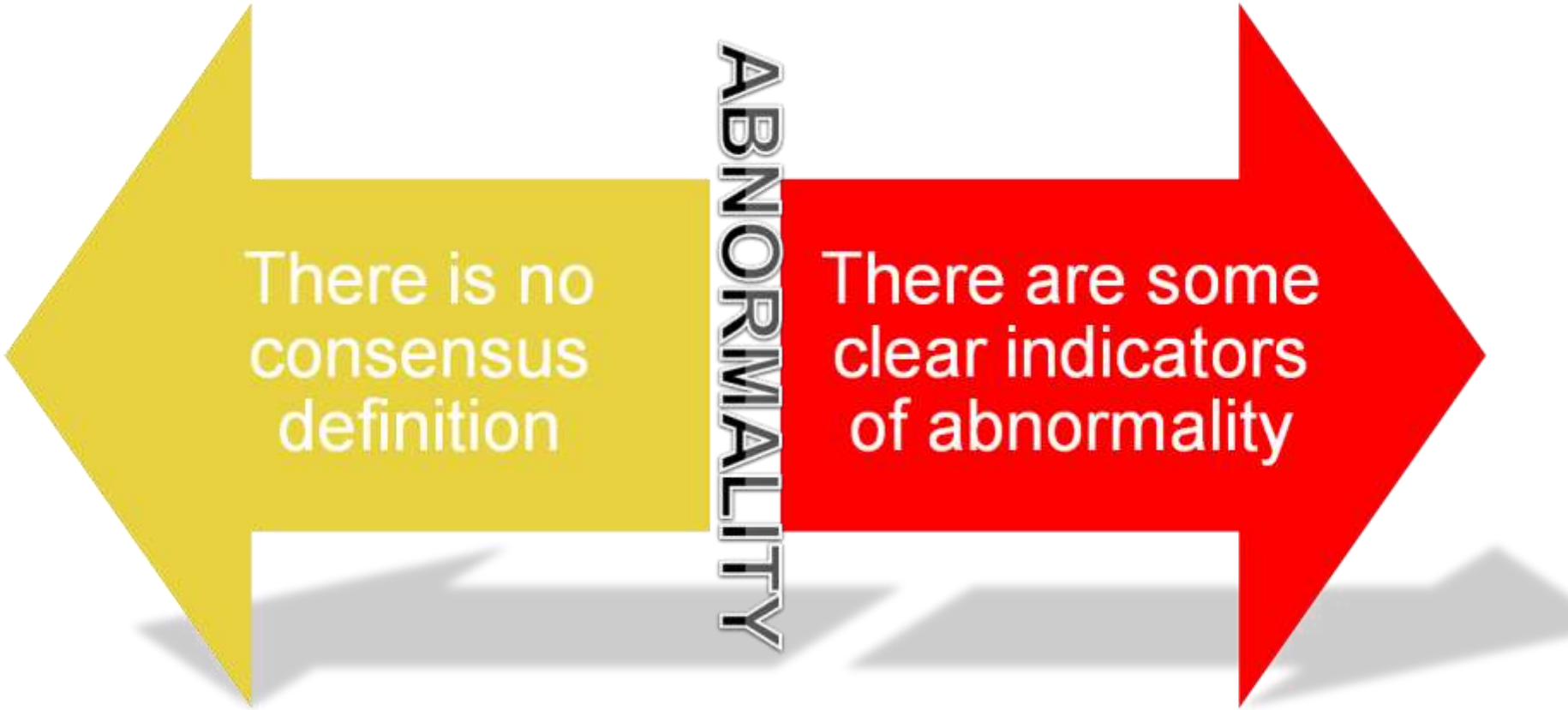
1.7 Explain why a control (or comparison group) is necessary to adequately test a hypothesis.

1.8 Discuss why correlational research designs are valuable, even though they cannot be used to make causal inferences.

1.9 Explain the key features of an experimental design.

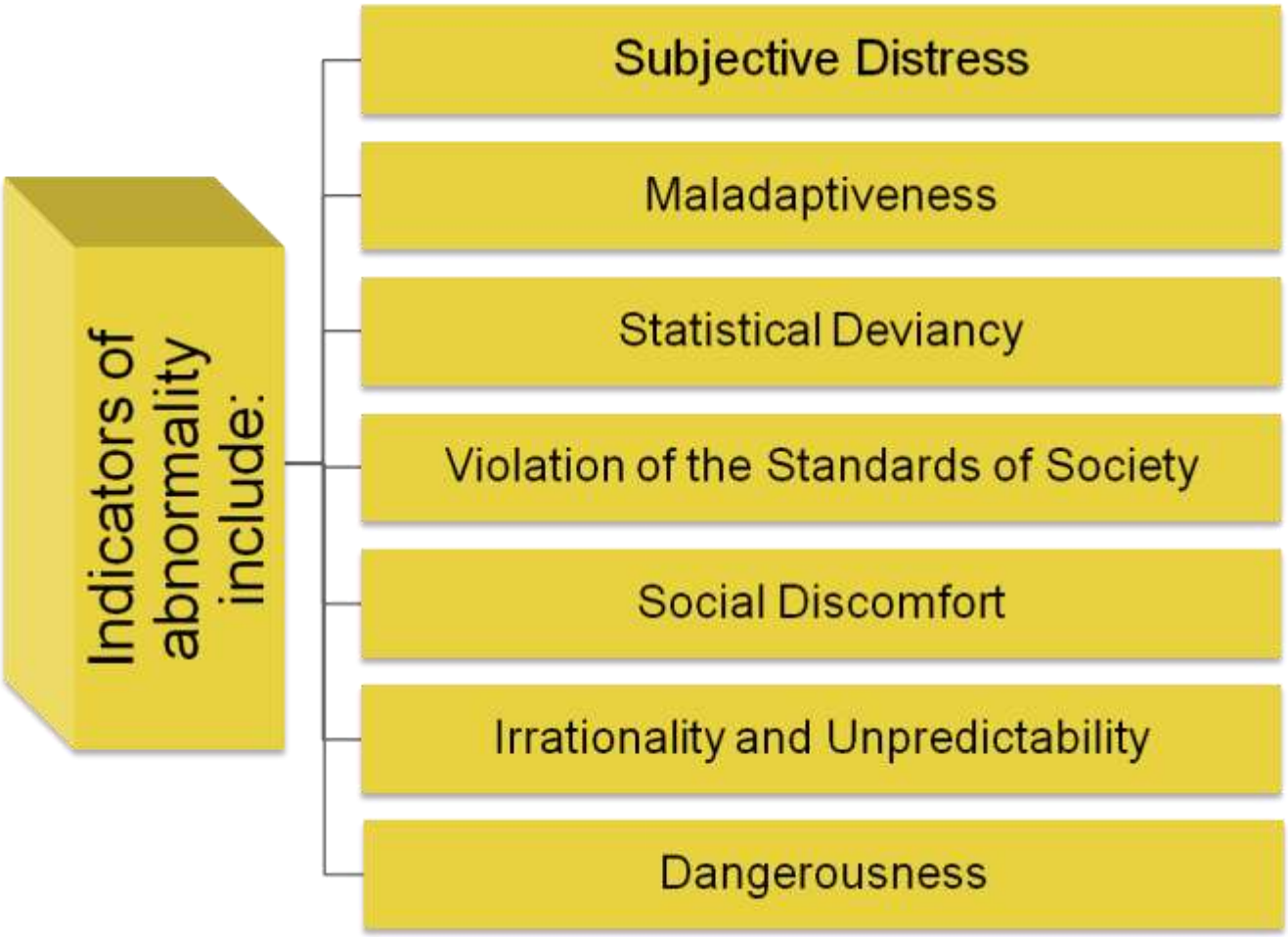
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

What Do We Mean by Abnormality?



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Indicators of Abnormality

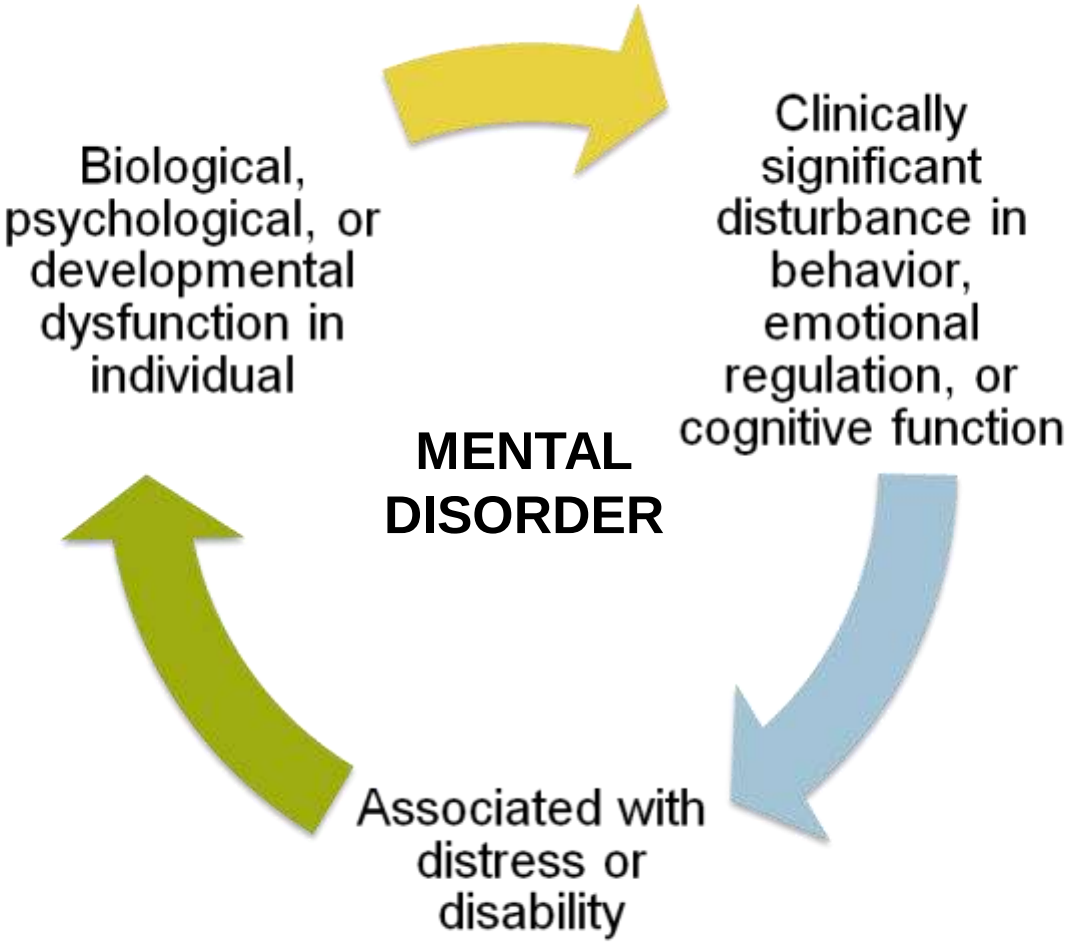


Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Indicators of Abnormality

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

The *DSM-5* Definition of Mental Disorder



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

The *DSM-5* Definition of Mental Disorder

- ICD-10
  - Another psychiatric classification system
  - Has similarities and differences with *DSM-5*
  - Used in U.S. and other countries

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Classification and Diagnosis

- Classification Systems
  - Provide nomenclature and common language
  - Allow information structuring
  - Facilitate research
  - Establish the range of problems to address

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Classification and Diagnosis

- Disadvantages of Classification
  - Loss of individual's information
  - Stigma and stereotyping associated with diagnosis
  - Self-concept impacted by diagnostic labeling

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

How Can We Reduce Prejudicial Attitudes Toward People Who Are Mentally Ill?

- Negative reactions are widespread global phenomena
  - Understanding of neurobiological basis does not lessen stigma
  - Contact with individuals does not lessen stigma

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

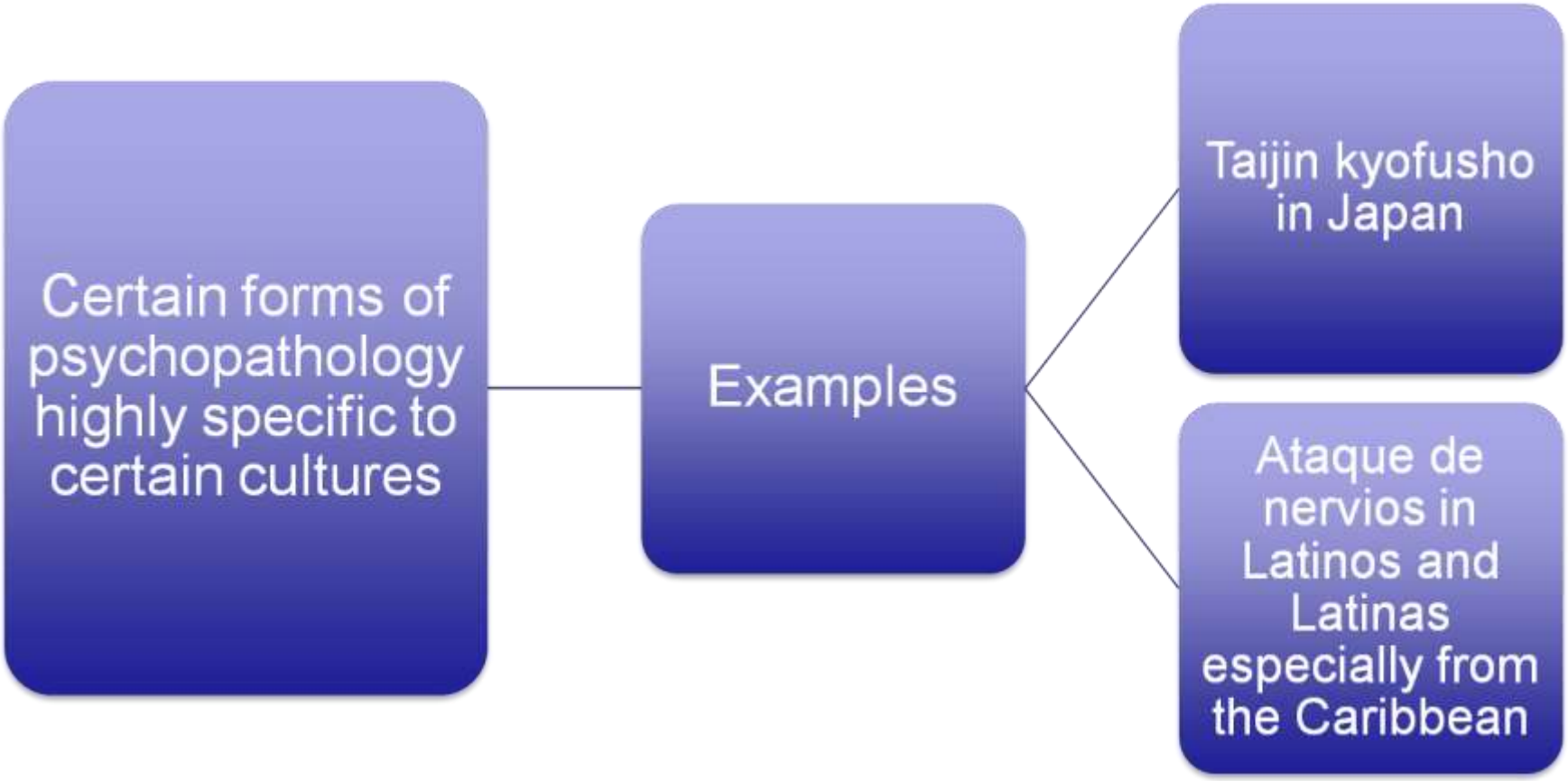
Culture and Abnormality

Cultural factors influence

- Presentation of disorders found worldwide
- Certain forms of highly culture-specific psychopathology

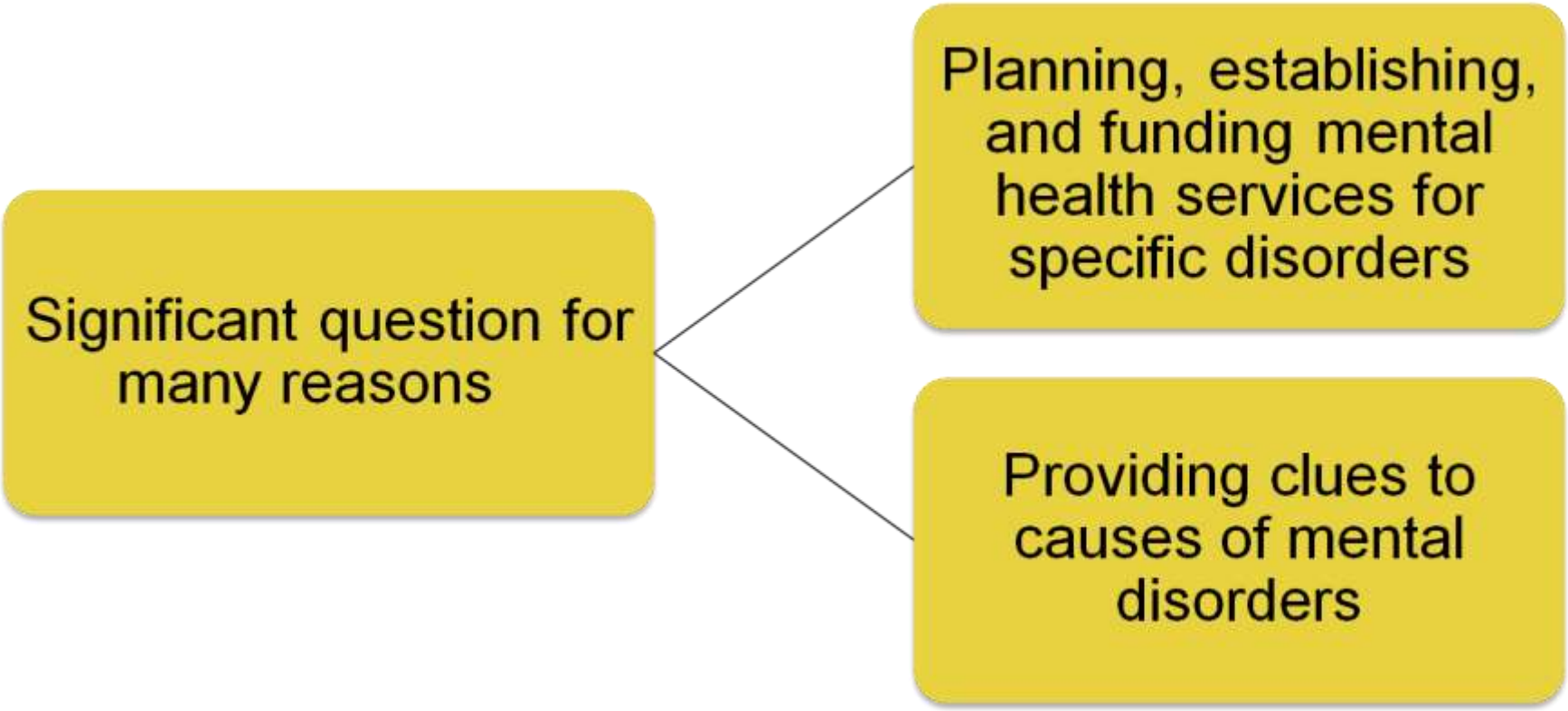
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Culture-Specific Disorders



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

How Common Are Mental Disorders?



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

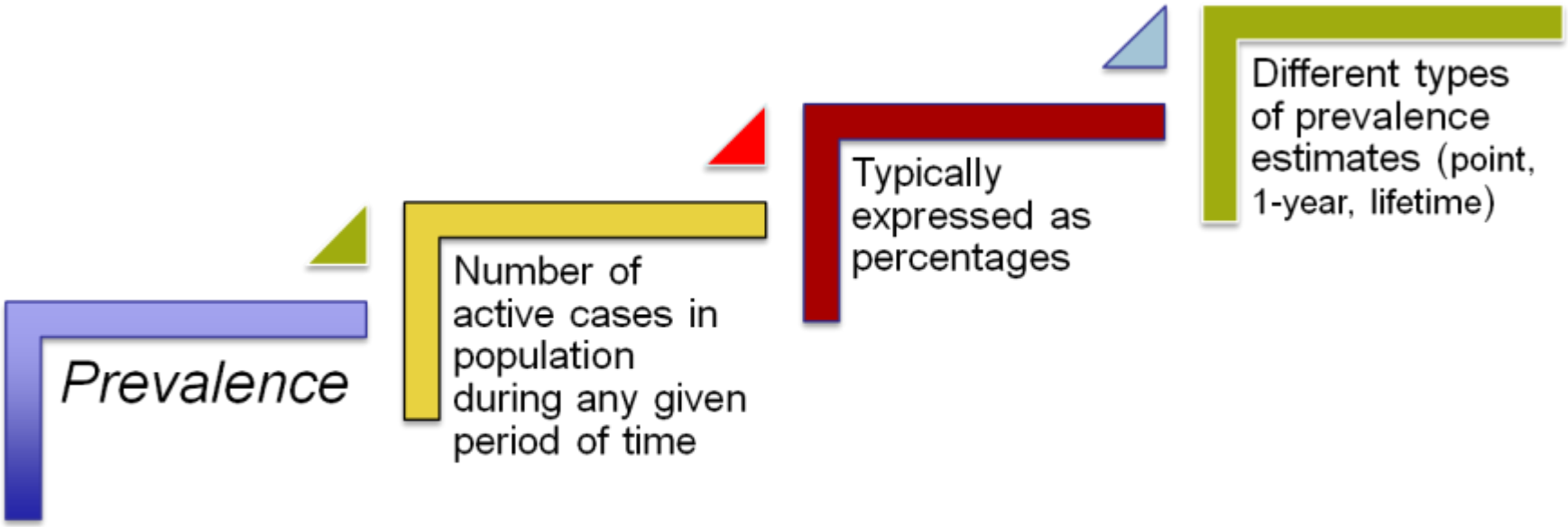
Prevalence and Incidence

Epidemiology

- Study of distribution of diseases, disorders, or health-related behaviors in a given population

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Prevalence and Incidence



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Prevalence and Incidence

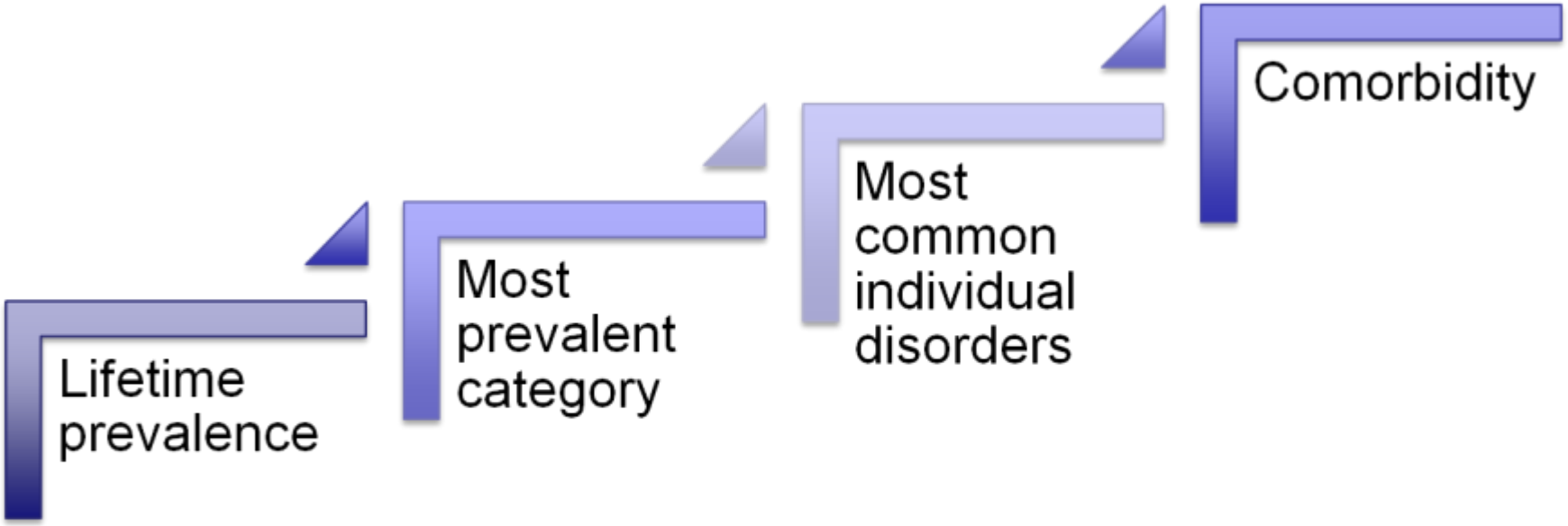
Incidence

Number of new cases in population over given period of time

Incidence figures are typically lower than prevalence figures

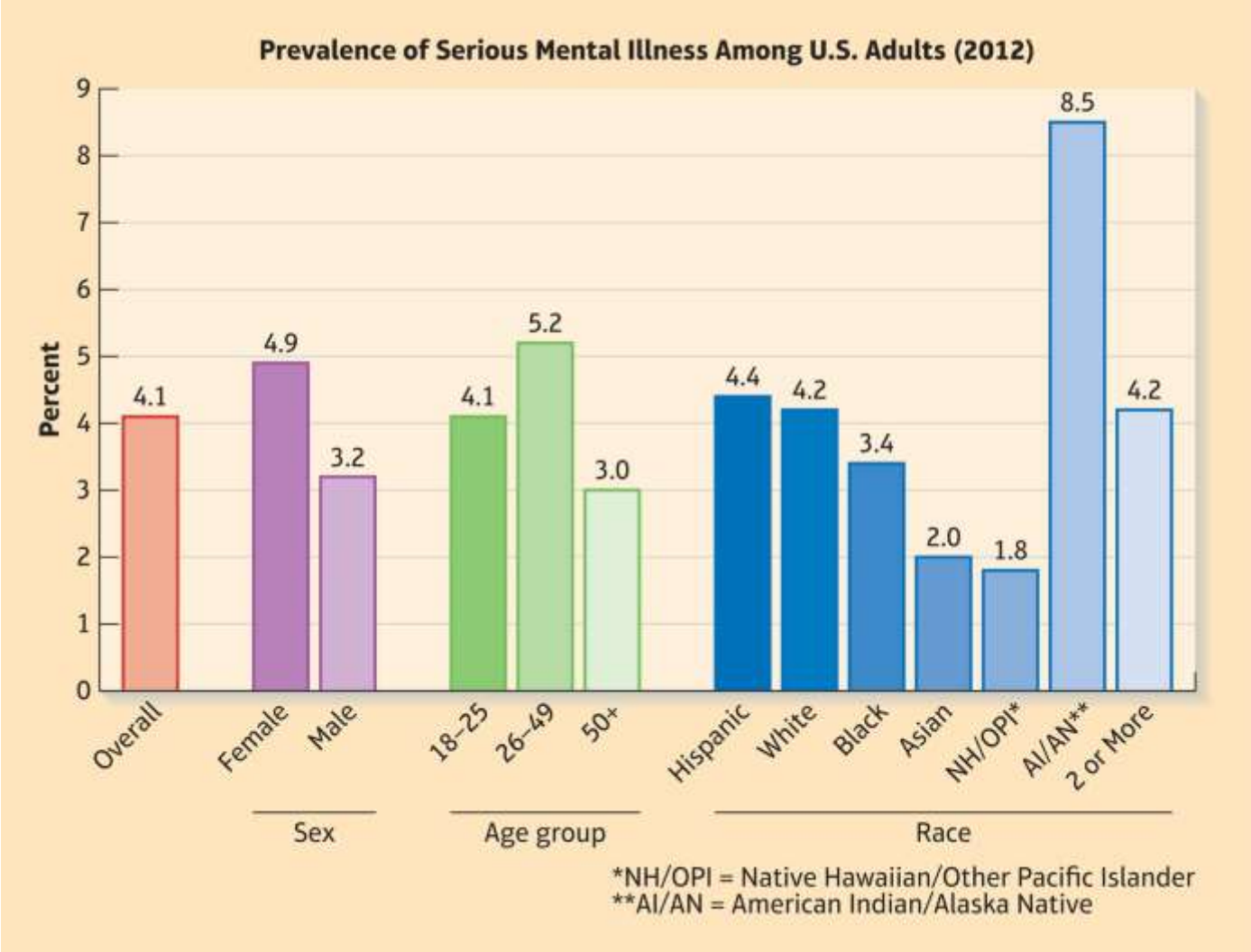
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Prevalence Estimates for Mental Disorders



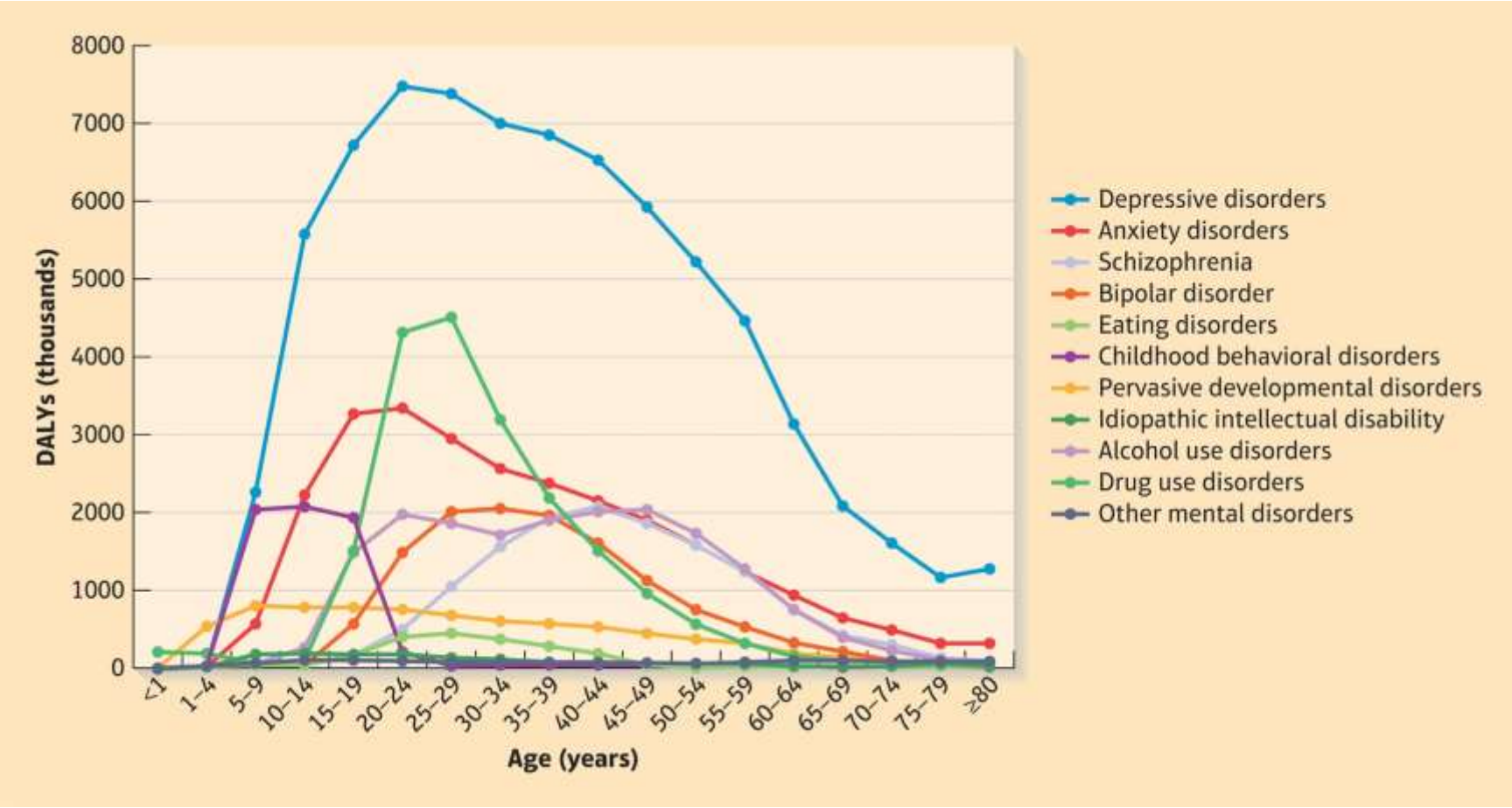
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Figure 1.1 Prevalence of Serious Mental Illness Among U.S. Adults (2012)
Rates of severe mental illness are higher in women, people ages 26 to 49, and some minority groups. (Data courtesy of SAMHSA)



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Figure 1.2 The Burden of Mental Illness for Different Disorders Across the Lifespan
Disability adjusted life years (DALYs) for various mental and substance use disorders are shown according to age. DALYs represent the total (worldwide) number of otherwise healthy years of life that are lost or profoundly impacted because of the disorder. Depression causes the greatest total disability. This is because depression is a relatively common disorder.
(Adapted from Whiteford et al., 2013. *Global burden of disease attributable to mental and substance use disorders: findings from the Global Burden of Disease Study 2010.* Lancet, 382, 1580.)



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Treatment

Not all people receive treatment

Vast majority of treatment is done on outpatient basis

Inpatient hospitalization typically in psychiatric units

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Mental Health Professionals

Diagnosis and assessment involves participants who

- Play differing roles in the process
- Gather comprehensive evaluation patient data

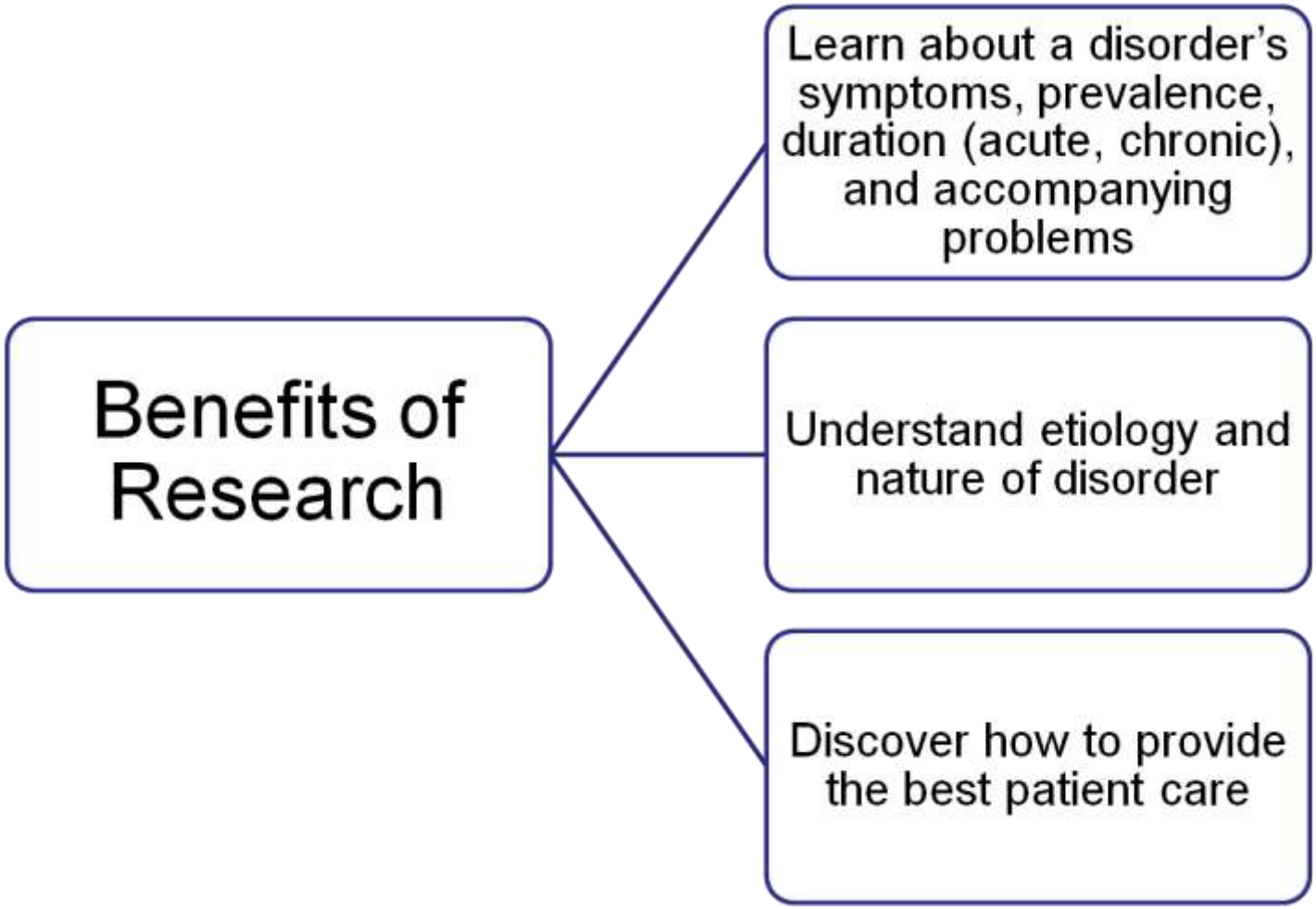
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Types of Mental Health Professionals

How many can you name?

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Research Approaches in Abnormal Psychology



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Sources of Information

- Case studies
- Self-report data
- Observational approaches

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Case Studies

- Specific individual observed and described in detail
- Subject to bias of author of case study
- Conclusion have low generalizability

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Self-Report Data

Participants asked to provide information about themselves

Interviews and Questionnaires

May be inaccurate

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Observational Approaches

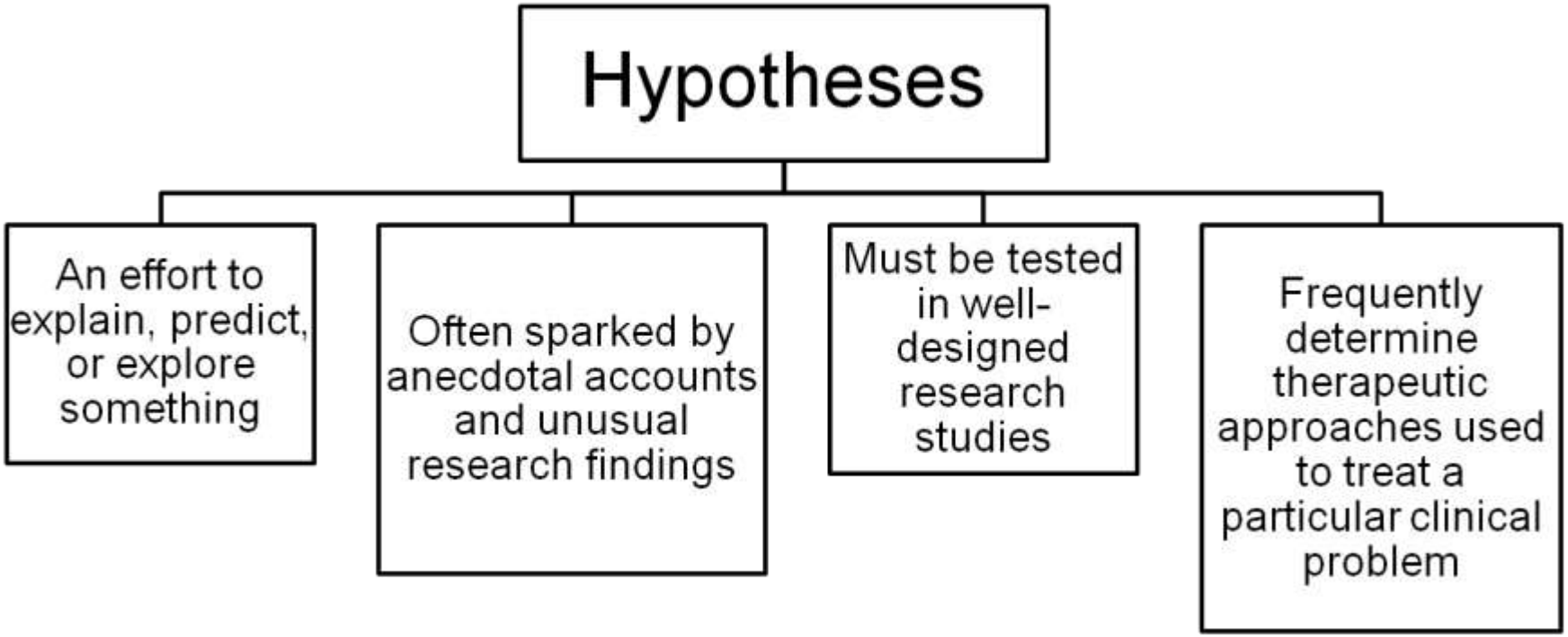
Collecting information without asking participants directly for it

Outward behavior can be observed directly

Biological variables can be observed via technologically advanced methods

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Forming and Testing Hypotheses



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Sampling and Generalization

Who should researchers include in a study?

- Individuals who are similar in their behavioral abnormalities (representative)
- Study group should mirror underlying population in all important ways
- Large, randomly selected groups are ideal

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Sampling and Generalization

Finding research participants

- Samples of convenience (using subjects who are easily accessible)
- Online recruitment of subjects (Amazon's Mturk)

Disadvantages

- Not a representative sample of the population as a whole

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Internal and External Validity

Internal validity
=
methodologically sound

External validity
=
generalizability

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

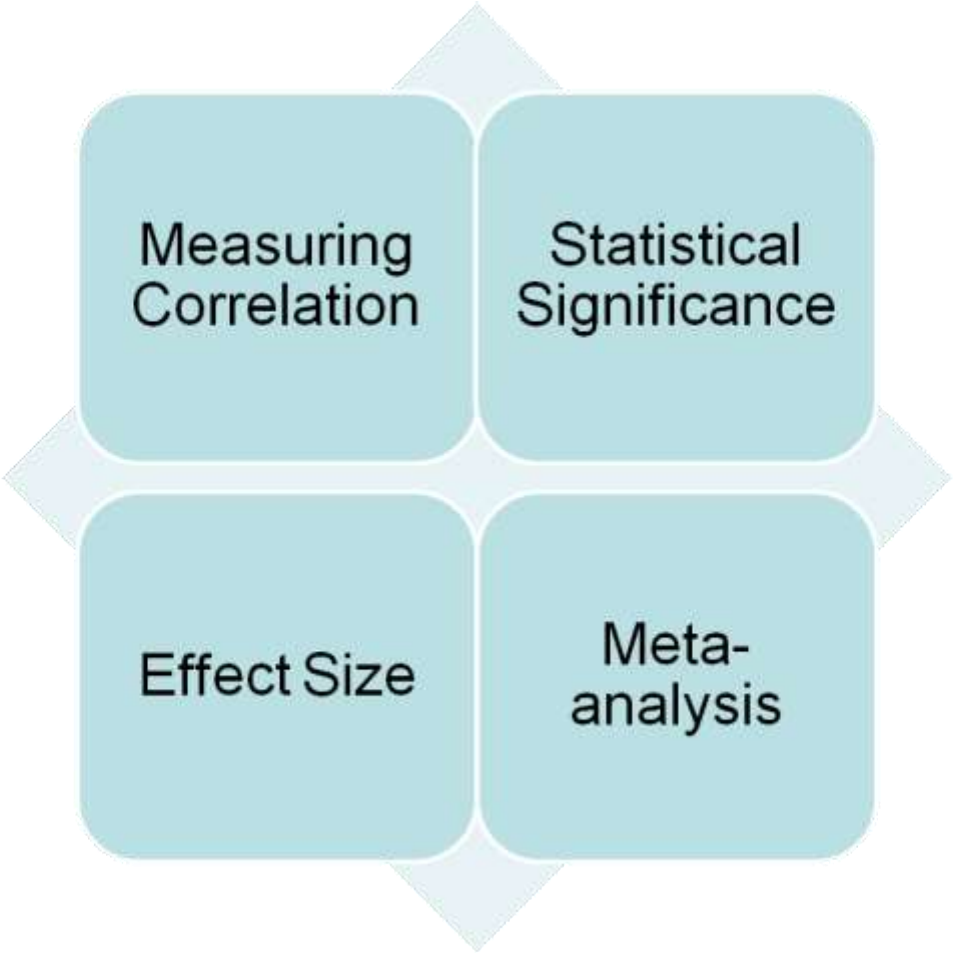
Criterion and Comparison Groups

Complete the following sentence:

To test hypotheses, researchers use a comparison (control) group of people who _____.

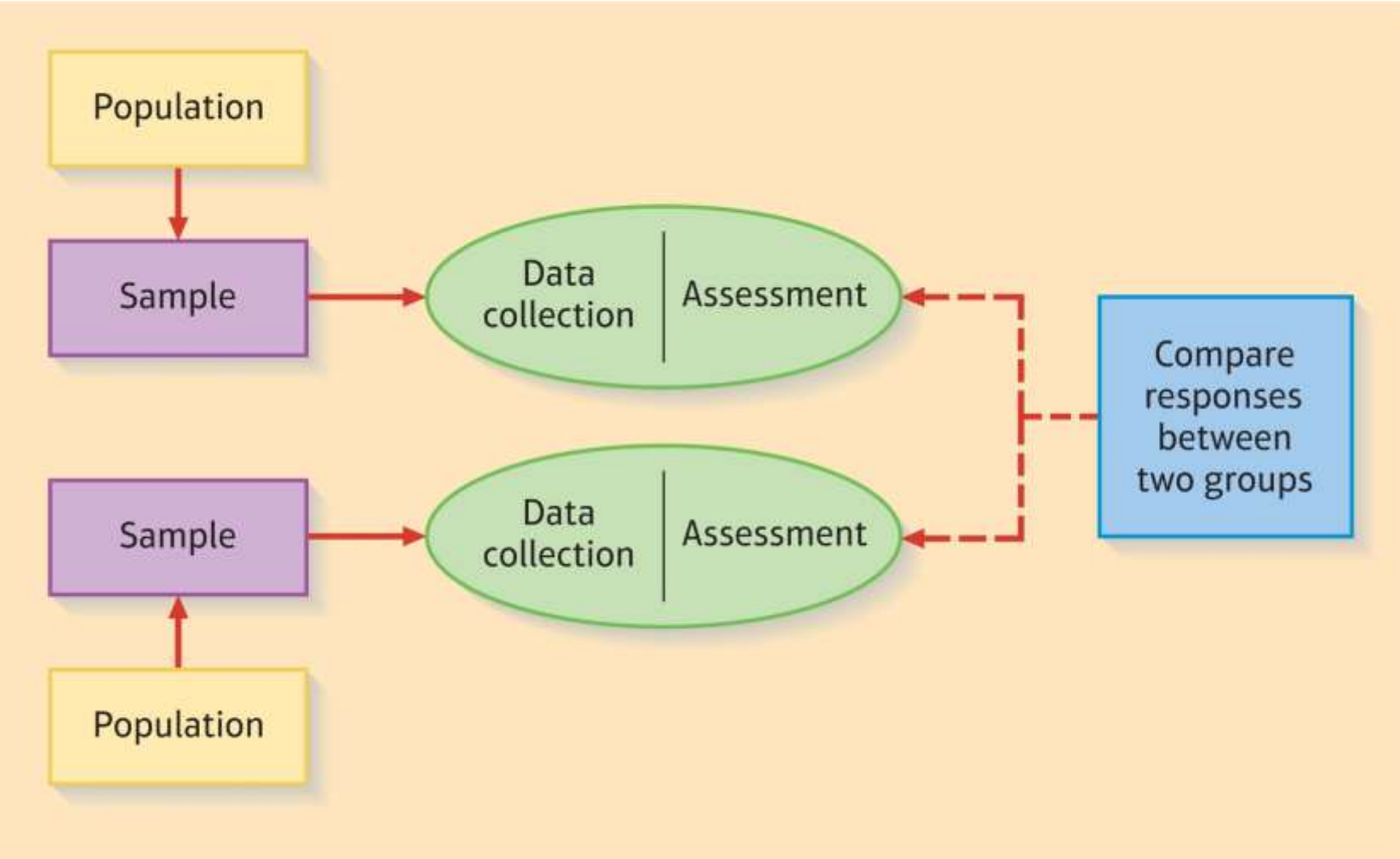
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Correlational Research Designs



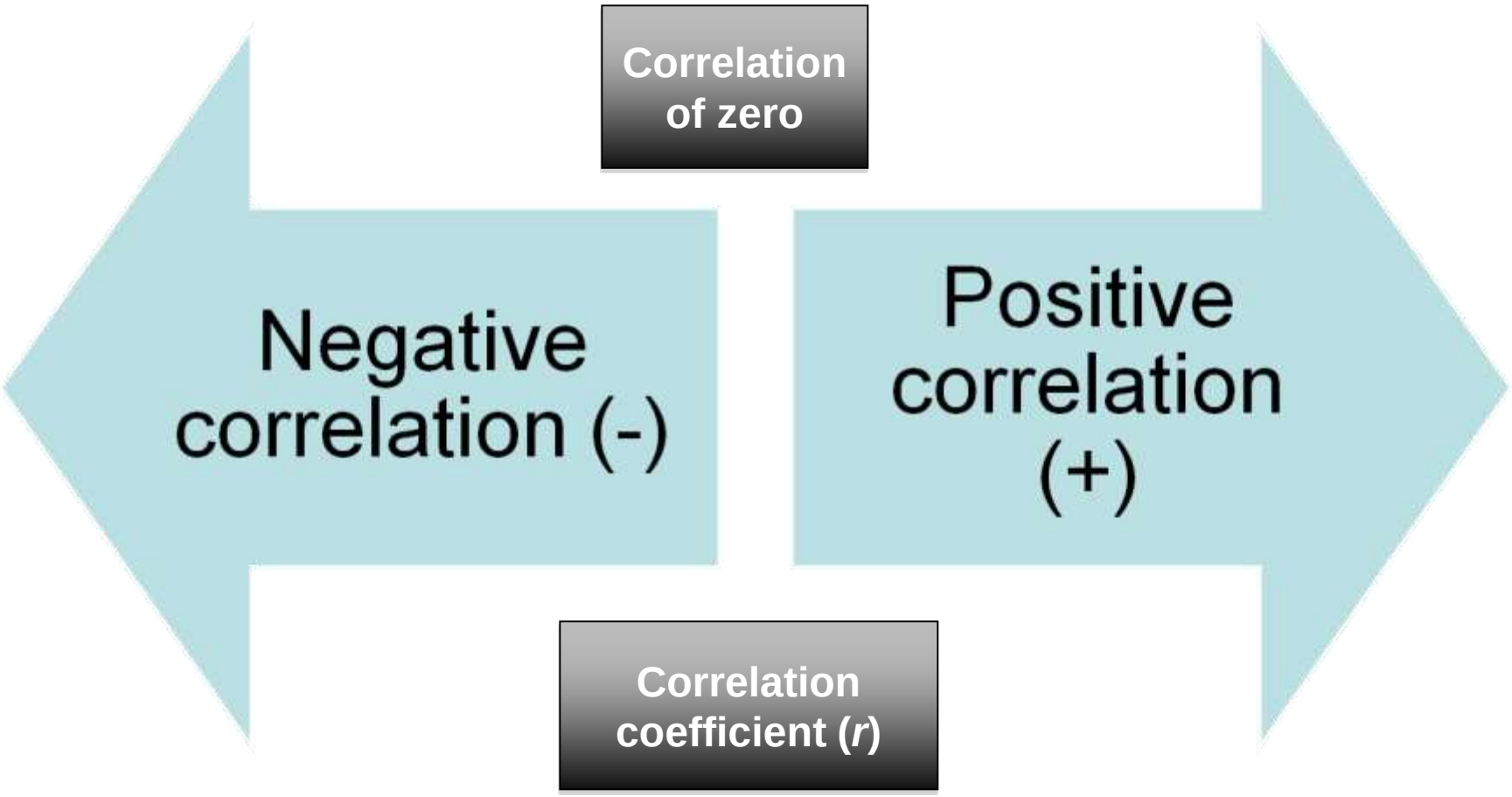
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Figure 1.4 Correlational Research Designs
In correlational research, data are collected from two different samples or groups and are then compared.
(Adapted from Petrie & Sabin, 2000. *Medical Statistics at a Glance*. Oxford, UK: Blackwell Science Ltd.)



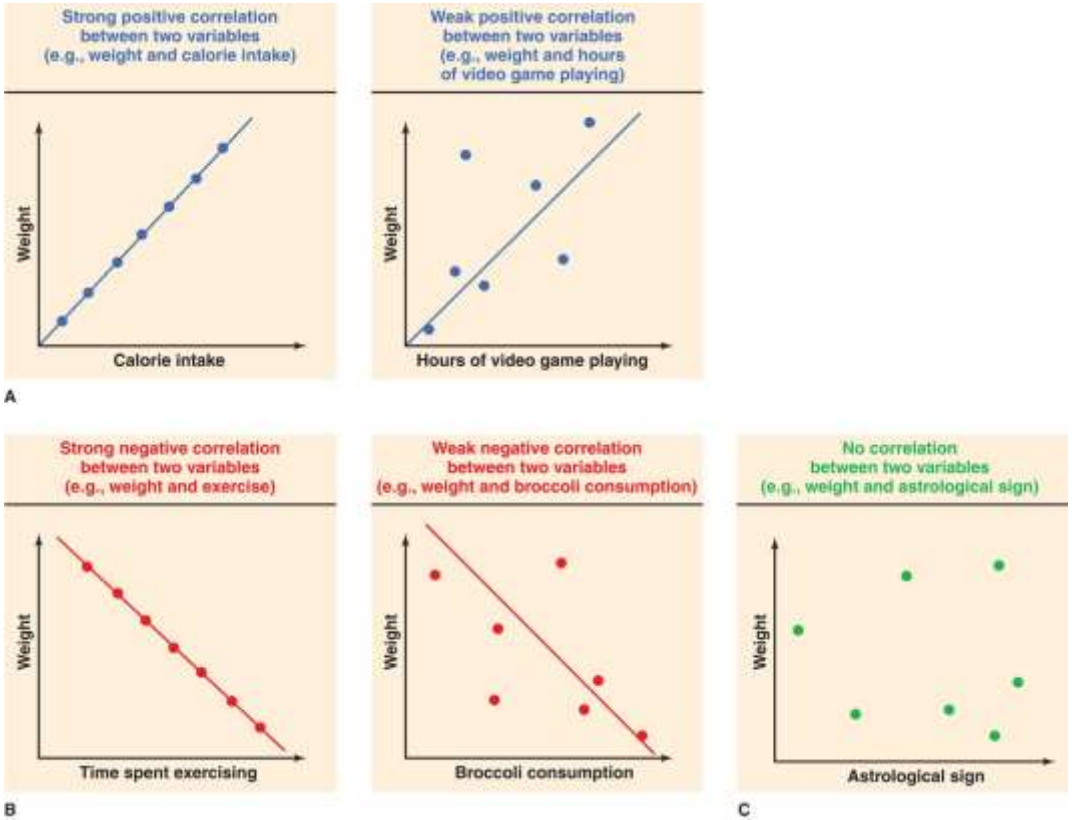
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Measuring Correlation



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Figure 1.5 Scatterplots of data illustrating positive, negative, and no correlation between two variables. Dots indicate a given person's score on the two variables of interest. A strong positive correlation (*r* − + 1.0) means that high scores on one variable are associated with high scores on the second variable, creating a forward-sloping straight line. For example, we would expect there to be a positive correlation between weight and the number of calories eaten per day. When there is a strong negative correlation (*r* − −1.0), high scores on the first variable are associated with low scores on the second variable, creating a backward-sloping straight line. A relevant example here would be the association between weight and time spent exercising per day. When there is no correlation (r = 0), scores on the independent variable tell us nothing about scores on the dependent variable. An example here might involve weight and astrological sign.



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Statistical Significance

$p < .05$

Less than 5 in 100 chance that correlation would happen by chance

Both strength of correlation and size of sample influence statistical significance

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Effect Size

- Reflects the size of association of variables
- Independent of sample size
- Used to compare the strength of findings from different studies

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Meta-Analysis

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

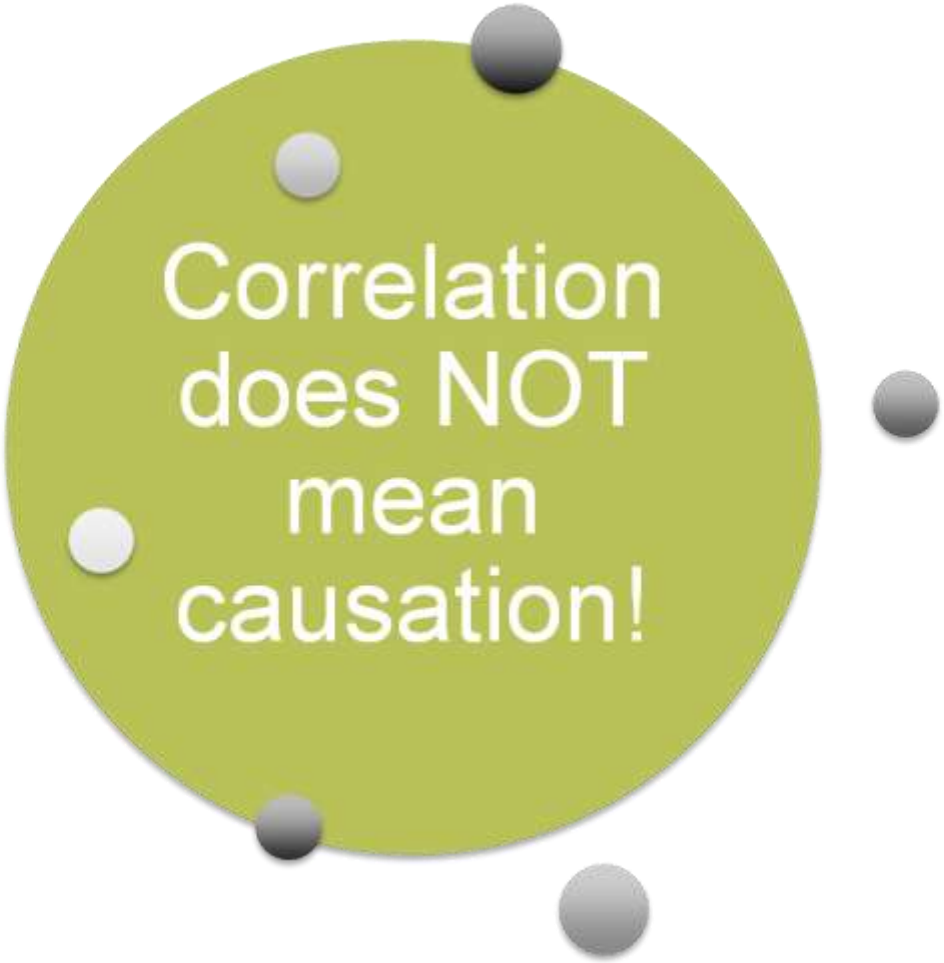
Correlations and Causality

If two variables are correlated, there are multiple possible reasons for this.

How many reasons can you identify?

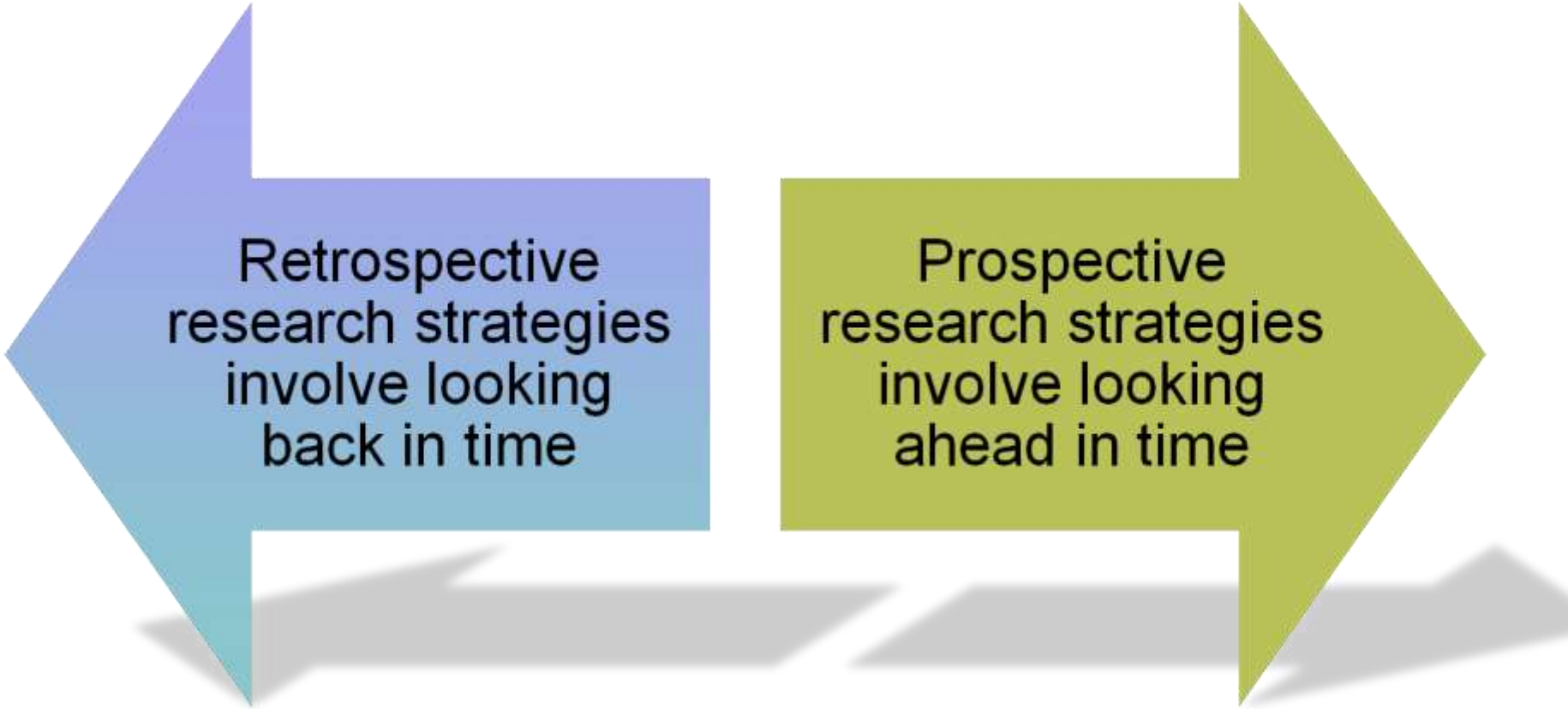
Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Correlations and Causality



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Retrospective versus Prospective Strategies



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

The Experimental Method in Abnormal Psychology

Studying the Efficacy of Therapy

Single-Case Experimental Designs

Animal Research

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

The Experimental Method in Abnormal Psychology

To draw conclusions about causality, resolve questions of directionality

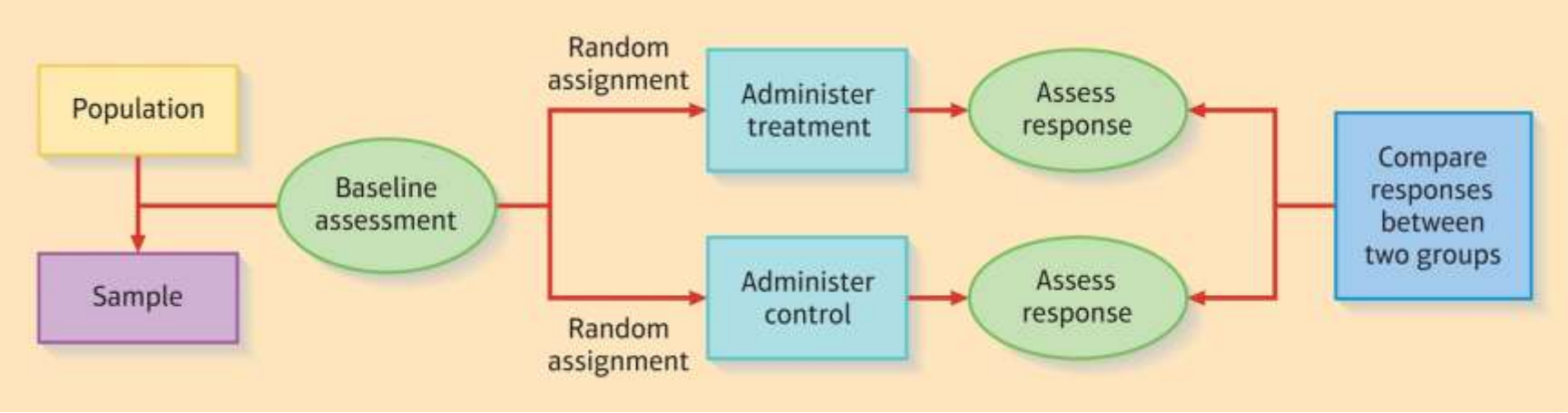
- Scientists control all factors except *independent variable*
- Actively manipulate independent variable
- If *dependent variable* changes as independent variable changes, it is regarded as a cause of the outcome

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Figure 1.6 Experimental Research Designs

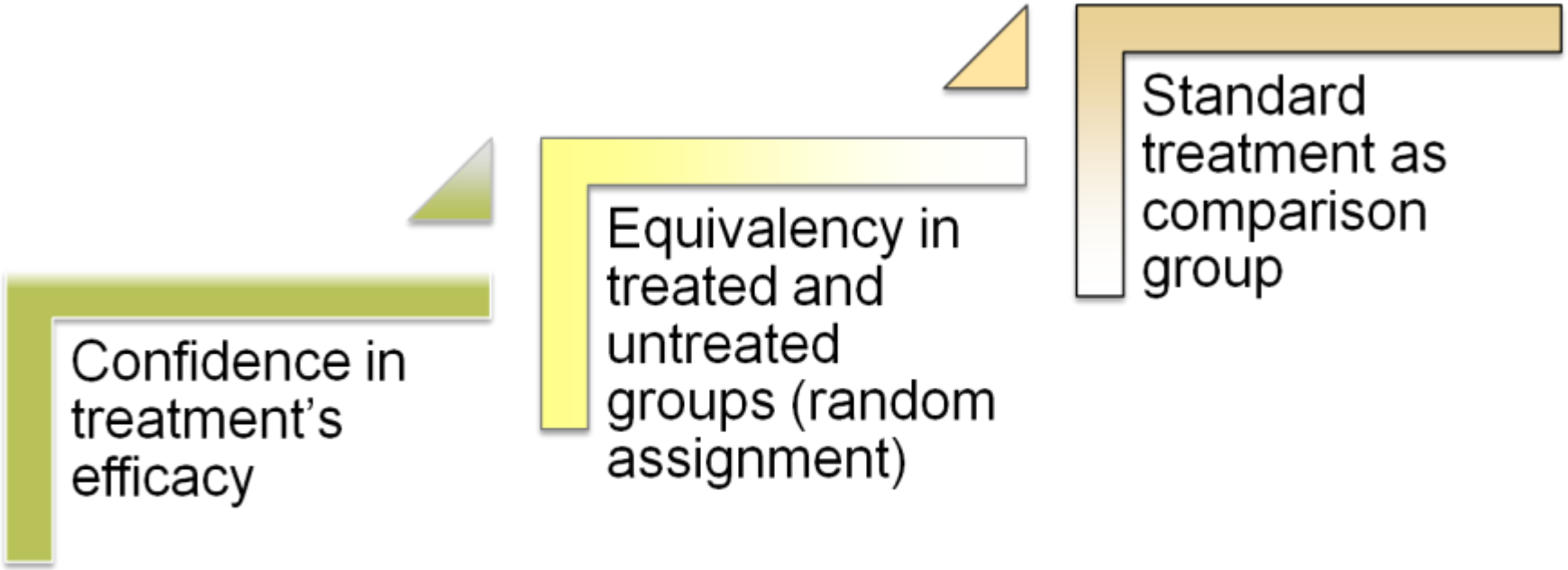
In experimental research, participants are assessed at baseline and then randomly assigned to different groups (e.g., a treatment and a control condition). After the experiment or treatment is completed, data collected from the two different groups are then compared.

(Adapted from Petrie & Sabin, 2000. *Medical Statistics at a Glance*. Oxford, UK: Blackwell Science Ltd.)



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Studying the Efficacy of Therapy



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Single-Case Experimental Designs

Single-case research designs

Make causal inferences in individual cases

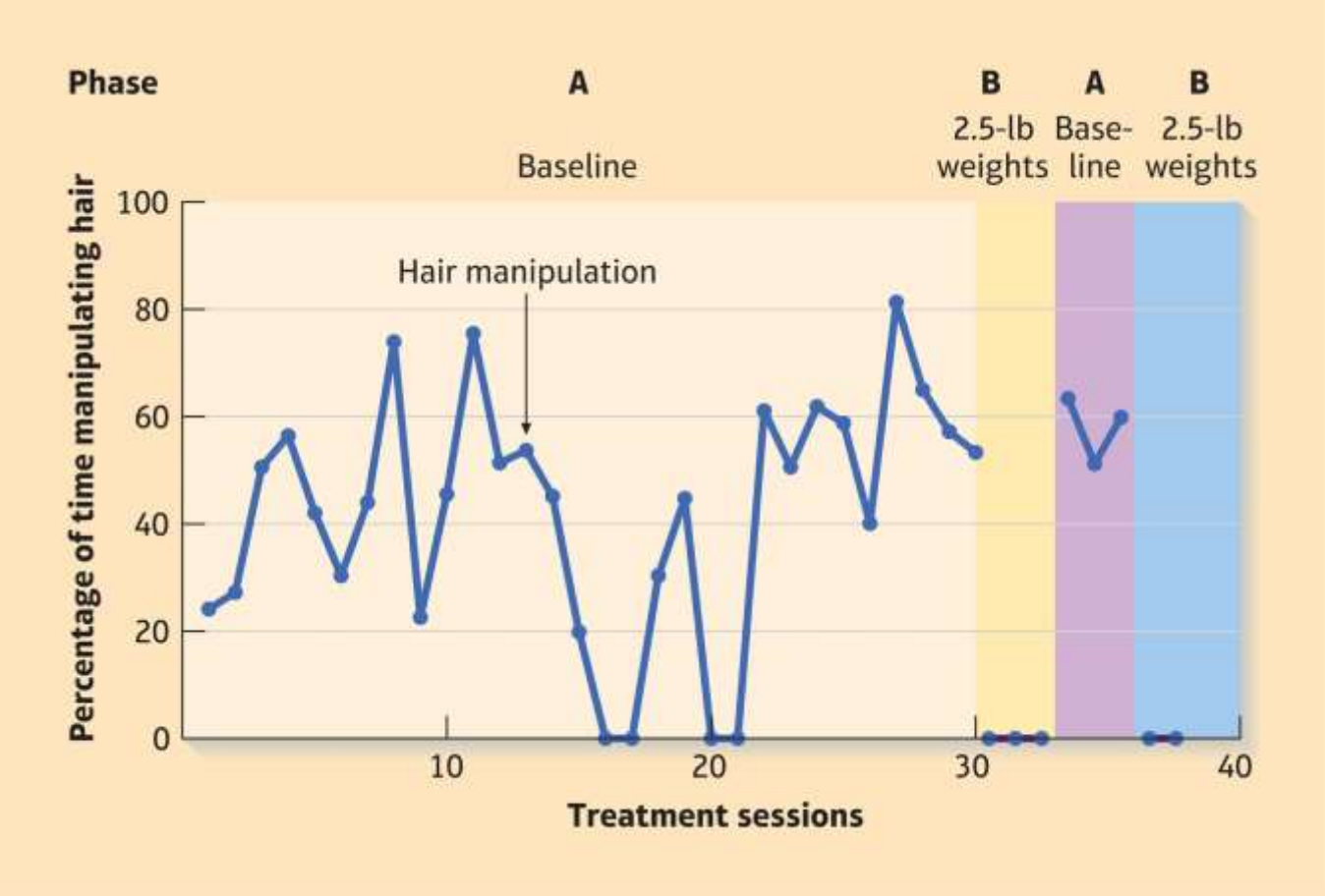
Involve alternating baseline condition and treatment condition

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Figure 1.7 An ABAB Experimental Design: Kris's Treatment

In the A phase, baseline data are collected. In the B phase, a treatment is introduced. This treatment is then withdrawn (second A phase) and then reinstated (second B phase). In this example, hair manipulation declines with use of wrist weights, returns to pretreatment (baseline) levels when they are withdrawn, and declines again when they are reintroduced.

(Data adapted from Rapp et al., 2000. Treatment of hair pulling and hair manipulation maintained by digital-tactile stimulation. *Behavior Therapy*, 31, pp. 381–93.)



Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Animal Research

Factors to consider

- Ethical issues
- Advantages
- Generalizability (analogue studies)

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Unresolved Issues

- Categorization of increasing numbers of people as mentally ill
- Financial interests of mental health professionals benefit from inclusive definitions
- How broadly should abnormality be defined?

Copyright © 2017 Pearson Education, Ltd. All Rights Reserved.